

Information for tutors:

These slides can be shared with students.

Tutor responsibilities:

- Review and approve low risk applications for your unit. Notify students by email and keep a copy of their informed consent letter.
- Advise students on how to lower the risk for medium and high risk applications.

If students pursue medium and high risk applications, they must submit to the Taught Student Ethics committee.

Ethics for students at RCA

Ethics in research at the RCA:

- protects the rights, privacy and welfare of participants and their personal data
- minimises risk to participants, researchers, and the institution
- strengthens and supports research

The Taught Student Ethics Committee deals with student research projects at the RCA.

Potential for harm:

- physical (pain, injury)
- social (public embarrassment, stigma)
- psychological (sensitive questions that might trigger negative emotions, shame, anxiety)
- legal (reporting sensitive data)
- How to avoid harm to participants and to yourself?
- How to work with vulnerable people?
- How to collecting individual data in a lawful, fair and transparent manner?

<https://intranet.rca.ac.uk/research-ethics-masters-students/>

Ethics for students at RCA

If you want to do research involving humans or other living beings, you have to get ethics clearance.

This includes:

- ❑ Interviews
- ❑ Surveys
- ❑ Workshops and codesign activities
- ❑ Photographs and videos
- ❑ Observation

You can't use the data
if you don't have consent.

Conducting medium or high risk research without ethics approval is considered academic misconduct.

Step 1: Review the [Ethics on Taught Programmes](#) intranet page

- The FAQ section is especially useful.

Step 2: Complete the [ethics checklist](#)

- You will receive a copy by email telling you if your project is low, medium or high risk. No one else receives this information. You can complete it as many times as you like.

Step 3: Based on the response from the ethics checklist...

Option A - If your research is: **Low risk with no involvement of humans**

- Proceed with your research.

Option B - If your research is: **Low risk involving humans**

- Email your tutor:
 1. Ethics Checklist (completed in step 2)
 2. [Taught Student Ethics Application Form](#)
 3. [Informed Consent letter](#) and/or [Survey Consent](#)
 4. A description of your research plan including questions you will ask participants.
- Your tutor may ask for more information, for revisions or they may approve. They will send you an email to confirm. After they have approved, you can proceed with your research.

Option C -If your research is: **Medium or high risk**

- Discuss with your tutor if there are options to make your project low risk instead.
- Medium and high risk projects require a full application to the Taught Student Ethics committee using this [google form](#).
- You may want to share a draft of your full application with your tutor to discuss how you can improve it and save time before submitting the form. You can use [these templates](#) and later copy the information into the google form.
- Once you receive approval from the Taught Student Ethics committee, email a copy of your application, consent form and correspondence with the committee to your tutor.

Step 4: Collect and Manage Your Data

Read this: <https://intranet.rca.ac.uk/during-a-project-storing-research-data/>

- Data could be digital or physical information you collect through your research.
- Make a plan for how will you capture, store and delete data in a way that is organised and secure. Write down the plan. If you are working in a group, nominate someone to take responsibility.
- Recommended secure storage: RCA Google Drive -limit your sharing permissions. Don't use personal accounts.
- Password protect and encrypt data on personal devices and hard drives. Store them in a safe place and don't use them for long-term storage.
- When possible, anonymize your data, removing any personal information that could be used to identify individuals. (guidelines here)
- Don't collect data you don't need.
- Delete your data in accordance with your consent form.

Travel

Even if you do not need ethics approval, **travel in and outside of the UK for research** requires the following:

Travel outside of the UK

- [Reviewing the guidance on the intranet](#)
- Completing the Overseas Work and Travel Form (on the intranet page)
- Possibly completing the Risk Assessment Form for Overseas Work and Travel if your trip meets criteria

Travel inside the UK with an overnight stay and/or plane trip

- [Reviewing the guidance on the intranet](#)
- Completing the UK Travel and Work form (on the intranet page)

The above must be reviewed by your tutor and approved by the Academic Lead (Elise Hodson).

****Note that tutors need 3 weeks to apply for college travel insurance on your behalf.**

Visa holders

- Complete the short absence request to be approved by the Academic Lead and Registry

[Read this general guidance](#)

Risk Assessment for Student Projects

Complete the [student project risk assessment form](#) if you are:

- conducting any of the activities in the [Student Project Risk Assessment Checklist](#)
- conducting research outside of the school or bringing external people into the school